



Where Asiko stands

Strengths, weaknesses, opportunities and threats — read against the competition, the voting formats, the fresh-channel pipeline, FAST training, the ad-server, the cost of data, and why the platform is free.

1 • The four quadrants

Strengths internal • positive

- ◆ **African-owned, and it's literally true.** Lagos-built; a 30-year Nigerian broadcaster at the helm. The foreign-owned incumbent can't claim it.
- ◆ **Founder's relationships.** Decades across Canal+, Iroko, Kaftan / Tattase — direct lines to content owners, advertisers and the associations (MIPAN, ADVAN).
- ◆ **Two-sided model.** FOA earns on every channel built; asiko.africa earns on the audience. Diversified, resilient.
- ◆ **An owned spine.** Media Icons owns ~28 of the 100+ channels — direct control of supply and quality, and enough to make the MVP real immediately. Not a neutral carrier.
- ◆ **You run the commercials.** Vested in the ad-server and monetisation for the platform and its channels — margin and control a channel that only carries feeds doesn't have.
- ◆ **Trust-first with creators.** "You own your HLS, you can leave" answers a decade of broken rev-share promises.

Weaknesses internal • negative

- ◆ **Pre-launch, pre-revenue.** The POC is a simulation; nothing is real yet.
- ◆ **Team is assembled but unproven together on this.** Media Icons staff across commercial, technology (4) and content — legal & finance forming. Depth is there; a FAST platform is a new thing for the group to execute as one.
- ◆ **Content depth.** The 28 owned channels still need enough programming to not feel repetitive, and partner content deals aren't signed — the long pole, though not a blank page.
- ◆ **Bootstrapped.** Can't yet fund guaranteed licence fees or serious marketing.
- ◆ **Web only.** No CTV apps — and CTV is where FAST money is.
- ◆ **asiko.africa not live.** Still on a github.io URL pending DNS.
- ◆ **Key-person risk.** The relationships and the vision sit with one person.

- ◆ **Category-exclusive sponsorship.** A premium, defensible ad product that plays to the founder's media-sales strength.
- ◆ **Free, no sign-up.** Maximum addressable audience — the FAST logic done properly.
- ◆ **Diaspora-first.** Underserved, higher-CPM, motivated advertisers (remittance, travel, education, diaspora banking).
- ◆ **Fresh-channel pipeline.** New channels flow continuously via FOA — not locked to a fixed catalogue. The 110-channel plan (2 per country + diaspora + flagship) is breadth no rival has.
- ◆ **Voting / competitions.** An engagement engine, a differentiated vertical, and a sponsorship magnet.
- ◆ **Low burn.** VOD2Live infrastructure is cheap and scales linearly.
- ◆ **Ahead on readiness.** A working POC plus a full document set — investor- and partner-ready before most peers.

- ◆ **Measurement not real.** Hard to prove audience to advertisers in the first months.
- ◆ **No ad demand signed.** No SSP or sales-house relationship yet.
- ◆ **Voting has no backend.** The competition rows are a mock; a real service (with anti-fraud) is unbuilt.
- ◆ **Compliance unbuilt.** Privacy, NDPA, cookie consent, NBC / APCON / music-licensing questions all open.

Opportunities external · positive

- ◆ **FAST is nascent in Africa & the diaspora.** A real first-mover window while it's exploding globally.
- ◆ **Nollywood + Afrobeats are global.** A content and cultural tailwind.
- ◆ **Burned content owners.** Openness to a trust-first, control-retained model.
- ◆ **African & diaspora brands lack a clean reach vehicle.** Direct demand for category-exclusive sponsorship.
- ◆ **Media-entrepreneurship wave.** Many creators want a channel and can't build one — FOA + training is the on-ramp.
- ◆ **Telco partnerships / zero-rating.** A telecom sponsor can zero-rate Asiko and remove the data-cost barrier on-continent.

Threats external · negative

- ◆ **AVO TV.** UK-capitalised incumbent — satellite footprint, 120+ channels, 20M viewers, apps everywhere; could add diaspora focus.
- ◆ **Deep-pocket streamers.** Showmax (MultiChoice / NBCU), Netflix, Prime — investing in African content; could bolt on FAST tiers.
- ◆ **YouTube.** The de facto home of Nollywood — free, vast, creators already there.
- ◆ **Global FAST platforms adding African channels** via aggregators — commoditises the content.
- ◆ **Cost of data & connectivity in Africa.** A structural ceiling on on-continent scale without zero-rating.

- ◆ **Government, cultural & embassy partnerships.** Soft power, distribution and non-dilutive funding.
- ◆ **Remittance companies as anchor sponsors.** Wise, LemFi, Sendwave and peers want diaspora attention.
- ◆ **Diaspora CTV penetration is high.** Roku / Fire TV are already in those homes.
- ◆ **Diaspora audience data is scarce and valuable** — an insight product in its own right.
- ◆ **Live tentpoles.** Competition finales, concerts, sport — sponsorable events that drive tune-in.

- ◆ **Low African ad CPMs / market cyclicity.** Diaspora is better but contested.
- ◆ **Piracy.** Rampant for African content — undercuts licensing value.
- ◆ **Regulation.** NDPA (data), NBC (broadcast licensing for "TV"), APCON (ads), music-society disputes.
- ◆ **Currency & cross-border payments.** Naira volatility; paying content owners across borders.
- ◆ **Trust is fragile.** One slipped payment early and the graveyard lesson turns on you.
- ◆ **Infra dependency.** Early reliance on third parties (Eyevinn, Bunny).

2 • The threads, read as SWOT

THREAD	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	OPPORTUNITY	THREAT
Competition (AVO & peers)	African-owned; creator-friendly; premium ad model AVO lacks	No scale, no satellite, no apps yet	AVO is foreign-owned — a narrative you can win; peers haven't done diaspora-first FAST	AVO could copy the diaspora play with far more capital
Voting	Engagement + a sponsorable format; telco SMS/USSD voting revenue	No backend, no anti-fraud, unproven	Competition formats as tentpoles; voting-revenue share with creators; telco tie-ins	Vote fraud; regulatory scrutiny of paid voting; format fatigue
Fresh channels (FOA pipeline)	Continuous supply; network effects; 110-channel breadth	Quality control; every channel still needs an audience	2-per-country coverage no rival has; a channel-owner flywheel	Channel glut → a discovery problem; low-quality channels dilute the brand
FAST training	A revenue line; a funnel into FOA; positions Asiko as the category's educator; the Playbook + founder credibility	Delivery capacity; a distraction risk from the core	Large unmet demand; partnerships with film schools, guilds, associations; grant funding	Free tutorials elsewhere; YouTube; consultants undercutting

THREAD	STRENGTH	WEAKNESS	OPPORTUNITY	THREAT
Ad-server side	Category-exclusive = premium & defensible; founder's direct sales relationships	No ad server / SSP wired; low fill & CPM until there's scale; measurement not real	Diaspora inventory is scarce and wanted; high-margin direct sponsorship; an SSP partnership	Discrepancies & invalid traffic; low African CPMs; walled gardens competing for the same budgets
Cost of data & how to watch	Diaspora watches on wifi / unlimited — no barrier there	On-continent viewers pay data even for a free service; web-only reach	Telco zero-rating (a category-exclusive telecom sponsor); low-bitrate & audio-only modes; PWA + CTV	Data cost is a hard ceiling on African scale; connectivity gaps

3 · Why Asiko is free — and the cost of data

Why free

- ♦ **The FAST logic.** Remove the paywall → maximise viewers → monetise attention with ads. A subscriber is worth more per head; a free viewer base is worth more in total, and it's the only base a category-exclusive sponsor will pay a premium to reach.
- ♦ **The market reality.** Low card penetration, subscription fatigue, and "never pay for TV again" is a message that lands in Africa and the diaspora alike.
- ♦ **The graveyard lesson.** The single most common way African FAST platforms die is pivoting to subscription when ad revenue is slow — which shrinks the very audience the ad model needs. Staying free is a discipline, not a default.

The cost of data — the real barrier, and how it's handled

Free-to-watch still costs the viewer data or airtime. That's the ceiling on on-continent reach. The levers:

- ♦ **Low-bitrate & audio-only modes.** A 240–360p option, and audio-only for music and talk channels — a fraction of the data.
- ♦ **A light player & aggressive edge caching.** Bunny CDN close to the viewer; a small app shell.
- ♦ **Telco zero-rating.** The strongest lever: a telecom brand as Asiko's category-exclusive sponsor *zero-rates* Asiko on its network — the viewer pays no data, the telco gets exclusive presence and a differentiated product. This is where the ad model and the access problem solve each other.

- ♦ **Diaspora-first sequencing.** The diaspora watches on home wifi and unlimited mobile plans — no data barrier — which is another reason to win that market first.

How to watch

SURFACE	STATUS
Web — asiko.africa	POC live; brand domain pending DNS
PWA (installable)	MVP — works from the same codebase
CTV — Roku, Fire TV, Samsung, LG	Pilot phase; diaspora priority
Embed on partner sites	MVP — Asiko-hosted iframe, domain-locked
Mobile app (iOS / Android)	Post-MVP
FOA channels on other platforms	Wherever a channel owner chooses to flight — non-exclusive

4 • The impact on media entrepreneurship

This is the mission, and it doubles as the moat. Asiko lowers the barrier to running a media business in Africa — and keeps the ownership African.

- ♦ **A channel without a broadcast licence, a satellite deal or a bank backer.** A creator with content and an idea can launch a linear channel to a global audience through FOA. That door was previously closed.
- ♦ **Ownership stays with the creator.** They own their HLS, license non-exclusively, keep global rights. The opposite of signing your catalogue away.
- ♦ **A monetisation path that isn't YouTube's.** No 45% platform cut, no algorithm owning your discovery, no demonetisation roulette — a linear channel, a guide slot, and a rev-share you can read.
- ♦ **African ad budgets to African content.** Category-exclusive sponsorship channels local and diaspora ad spend into local channels instead of into global platforms.
- ♦ **Capacity-building.** FAST training turns "I want a channel" into people who can actually run one — growing the whole ecosystem, not just Asiko's supply.
- ♦ **New revenue for emerging talent.** Voting and competition formats create visibility and income for creators and contestants who'd otherwise have no route to an audience.

- ♦ **The net effect:** Asiko as *infrastructure for an African media economy* — an enabler that grows the pie — rather than another platform extracting from it.

For investors, this is the line: the ad revenue is the return; the media-entrepreneurship impact is why the doors open — with content owners, associations, telcos, cultural bodies and development funders who would never help "another streaming platform."

Asiko TV — strategic SWOT

Media Icons Africa · 7 September 2026 · reads against The African FAST Platform Playbook, the AVO comparison and the 110-channel strategy